

The parts of Medicare, and what each one pays for

Original Medicare is Part A and Part B. Part D is added for drugs. Part C is a different way to get it all.

PART A — Hospital

Inpatient hospital stays. Skilled nursing after a hospital stay. Hospice care. Some home health care.

PART B — Medical

Doctor visits. Outpatient care. Preventive screenings. Lab tests. Durable medical equipment.

PART D — Drugs

Prescription drugs you pick up at a pharmacy. Sold by private plans. Each plan covers its own list of drugs.

PART C — Medicare Advantage

A private plan that replaces Original Medicare. It must cover everything Parts A and B cover, usually includes Part D, and often adds extras. In exchange you use the plan's network of doctors and follow its approval rules.

Medicare does not pay for long-term custodial care, and Original Medicare has no yearly limit on what you pay.

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